

TAKEAWAYS

India must aim at strategic superiority by adopting 'human-in/on-the-loop' systems for lethal force and 'human-out-of-the-loop' for non-lethal applications

AI's challenges include data security concerns, unreliability and ethical issues about autonomous weapons

On the use of AI in defence, the debate is about balancing military modernisation/ strategic autonomy with ethical legal and operational challenges

How will India regulate its growing AI sector? Existing approaches may not suit it. It must identify negative AI consequences and develop targeted regulations

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gy. Europe has implemented stringent regulations on AI development and deployment. The US, on the other hand, has favoured a lighter regulatory touch, focusing on fostering innovation and maintaining its competitive edge. Balancing national interests with the need for global cooperation in addressing AI challenges will be a key consideration for policymakers.

India's Doctrinal Debate

India is at the crossroads, poised to become a major player in the global tech supply chain, with the AI sector seeing significant growth. Whether India should regulate AI and, if so, what path (modernisation or sovereignty) it should take is the question. Adopting existing approaches may not suit India; it should prioritise identifying specific negative AI consequences and develop targeted regulations, rather than adopting an existing 'comprehensive' law that may become outdated.

On the use of AI in defence, the debate revolves around balancing the urgent need for military modernisation and strategic autonomy while dealing with significant ethical, legal and operational challenges. Technology must never replace human judgement; it must amplify it. Success in battle will depend not on how intelligent, warfighting machines become, but how wisely humans choose to employ them. India must aim at achieving strategic superiority with an approach of adopting 'human-in/on-the-loop' systems for lethal force and 'human-out-of-the-loop' and autonomy for non-lethal applications like surveillance. It is not just about speed and control, it is about surviving and winning tomorrow's wars without losing our souls, countering non-state actors and security threats peculiar to India.

As the race continues and differing approaches play out, the global community and India must work together to harness the potential of AI while mitigating its risks, ensuring this powerful technology benefits humanity as a whole. Navigating the complexities of implementing AI in the military field requires careful consideration of not only technology but also moral, legal, ethical and organisational challenges and effective international collaboration and governance mechanisms. ■

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